

Notion setup guide — Yacoub's DevOps learning management system

This turns `Yacoub_Notion_Tasks.csv` (360 tasks across 61 days) into a working system. Setup takes about 30 minutes once. After that the daily routine is five clicks.

Part 1 — Import the CSV

1. Open Notion. In the left sidebar, hover over your workspace name and click **+** to create a new blank page. Call it **Yacoub DevOps Programme**.
2. On the empty page, type `/import` and choose **Import**.
3. Choose **CSV**, then select `Yacoub_Notion_Tasks.csv`.
4. Notion creates a new database with 360 rows. This takes a minute or two — let it finish.
5. Rename the database to **DevOps Tasks** (click the title at the top).

If you are on mobile, do the import on a laptop. Notion's mobile app cannot import CSVs. Everything afterwards works fine on mobile.

Part 2 — Fix the property types

Notion imports every column as plain **Text**. Five of them need changing or the views and dashboard will not work. Click each column header → **Edit property** → change **Type**.

Column	Change type to	Then do this
Date	Date	Notion will parse the <code>2026-09-07</code> format automatically
Status	Select	Add options in this order: <code>Not Started</code> , <code>In Progress</code> , <code>Blocked</code> , <code>Done</code> . Colour them grey, blue, red, green.
Category	Select	Options: <code>Udemy</code> , <code>Tech365</code> , <code>Practice</code> , <code>Lab</code> , <code>Project</code> ,

		GitHub , LinkedIn , Presentation , Revision , Capstone
Priority	Select	Options: High , Medium , Low
Week	Select	Options Week 1 through Week 9
GitHub Required	Select	Options: Yes , No
LinkedIn Required	Select	Options: Yes , No
Lab Required	Select	Options: Yes , No
Presentation Required	Select	Options: Yes , No
GitHub Evidence	URL	Yacoub pastes commit links here
LinkedIn URL	URL	Yacoub pastes post links here

Leave Task , Start Time , End Time , Course Section , Lecture Numbers , Lecture Titles , Task Description , Deliverable , Estimated Duration **and** Notes **as Text**.

Tip: when you change a column to **Select**, Notion offers to create the options from the existing values automatically. Accept that — it saves typing.

Part 3 — Add two formula properties

These power the dashboard. Click **+** at the far right of the columns → **Formula**.

Property name: Done? (used for all progress bars)

```
if(prop("Status") == "Done", 1, 0)
```

Property name: Is Today (optional, makes the TODAY view simpler)

```
if(formatDate(prop("Date"), "YYYY-MM-DD") == formatDate(now(), "YYYY-MM-DD"), tru
```

Part 4 — Create the ten views

At the top of the database, click **+ New view** for each. Set the **filter** and **sort** as shown, then rename the view.

1. TODAY ← this is the one Yacoub opens every morning

- Layout: **Table**
- Filter: `Date` → **Is** → **Today**
- Sort: `Start Time` → **Ascending**
- Hide properties: everything except `Task`, `Start Time`, `Category`, `Status`, `Lecture Numbers`, `GitHub Evidence`, `LinkedIn URL`, `Notes`
- **Drag this view to first position.** It should be the default.

2. THIS WEEK

- Layout: **Table**, grouped by `Day`
- Filter: `Date` → **Is within** → **The current week**
- Sort: `Date` **Ascending**, then `Start Time` **Ascending**

3. BOARD

- Layout: **Board**
- Group by: `Status`
- Filter: `Date` → **Is within** → **The current week** (otherwise 360 cards is unusable)
- Card preview: none; show `Date`, `Category`, `Priority`

4. CALENDAR

- Layout: **Calendar**
- Date property: `Date`
- Show properties on cards: `Task`, `Category`

5. SATURDAY LABS

- Layout: **Table**

- **Filter:** `Category → Is → Lab`
- **Sort:** `Date Ascending`

6. SUNDAY PRESENTATIONS

- **Layout:** **Table**
- **Filter:** `Category → Is → Presentation`
- **Sort:** `Date Ascending`

7. LINKEDIN

- **Layout:** **Table**
- **Filter:** `LinkedIn Required → Is → Yes`
- **Sort:** `Date Ascending`
- **Show** `LinkedIn URL` prominently — an empty cell means a missed post

8. GITHUB

- **Layout:** **Table**
- **Filter:** `GitHub Required → Is → Yes`
- **Sort:** `Date Ascending`
- **Show** `GitHub Evidence` prominently

9. BLOCKED ← the view Ade checks

- **Layout:** **Table**
- **Filter:** `Status → Is → Blocked`
- **Sort:** `Date Ascending`
- **Show** `Notes` — this is where Yacoub explains what he is stuck on

10. COMPLETED

- **Layout:** **Table**
- **Filter:** `Status → Is → Done`
- **Sort:** `Date Descending`

Part 5 — Yacoub's daily routine

This is the whole system from his side. Seven steps, most days under a minute of admin.

1. Open **TODAY**.
2. Read the tasks top to bottom — they are already in time order.
3. Start the first one, set `Status` → **In Progress**.
4. When finished, set `Status` → **Done**.
5. If `GitHub Required` is Yes, paste the commit URL into `GitHub Evidence`.
6. If `LinkedIn Required` is Yes, paste the post URL into `LinkedIn URL`.
7. If something went wrong or he got stuck, write it in `Notes` and set `Status` → **Blocked**.

The Blocked status is the important one. It is not an admission of failure — it is the signal that Ade should look. Being stuck for two hours and saying nothing is the failure.

Part 6 — Remote monitoring (Ade)

1. On the **Yacoub DevOps Programme** page, click **Share** → **Invite** → enter Ade's email → permission **Can edit** (or **Can comment** if you prefer read-only oversight).
 2. Ade opens the same workspace and uses these views:
 - **BLOCKED** — is he stuck on anything right now?
 - **THIS WEEK** — how much of the week is still `Not Started` on a Thursday?
 - **GITHUB** and **LINKEDIN** — are the evidence columns actually being filled in? Empty URL cells on past dates are the earliest warning sign that the habit is slipping.
 - **COMPLETED** — sorted newest first, this is the activity feed.
 3. Notion sends notifications on comments. Comment directly on a task row rather than messaging separately — the context stays attached to the work.
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Part 7 — Build the dashboard

Create a new page inside **Yacoub DevOps Programme** called **Dashboard**. Add these blocks. Every number updates itself — no manual admin.

Method: linked database views with rollups

For each metric below, type `/linked` on the Dashboard page, choose **Linked view of database**, select **DevOps Tasks**, then set the filter and switch the layout so it shows a count.

To display a count rather than rows: open the linked view → ... menu → turn on **Calculate** at the bottom of the table → choose **Count all** (or **Percent checked** where noted).

Dashboard metric	Linked view filter	Calculation
Overall course progress	<i>(no filter — all 360 tasks)</i>	Bottom bar → <code>Done?</code> → Sum , next to a Count all. Or <code>Status</code> → Percent per group
Weekly progress	<code>Date</code> is within the current week	<code>Status</code> → Percent per group , shows the Done share of this week
Labs completed	<code>Category</code> is Lab AND <code>Status</code> is Done	Count all (out of 47 lab tasks)
Projects completed	<code>Category</code> is Capstone or Project	Count all where Status is Done (4 total)
GitHub updates	<code>GitHub Required</code> is Yes AND <code>GitHub Evidence</code> is not empty	Count all (target: 63)
LinkedIn reports	<code>LinkedIn Required</code> is Yes AND <code>LinkedIn URL</code> is not empty	Count all (target: 61)
Tasks completed	<code>Status</code> is Done	Count all
Tasks remaining	<code>Status</code> is not Done	Count all

Blocked tasks	Status is Blocked	Count all — put this one at the top in red
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Layout suggestion

Use `/columns` to create a 3-column layout:

BLOCKED (red)	Overall progress	Weekly progress
Tasks completed	Tasks remaining	Labs completed
GitHub updates	LinkedIn reports	Projects completed

Then embed the **TODAY** view full-width underneath, so the dashboard doubles as the daily start page.

Milestone checklist

Add a simple to-do list at the bottom of the Dashboard with the nine weekly milestones:

- Week 1 — A multi-tier application running on AWS he built and can explain
- Week 2 — A Jenkinsfile that builds, tests, analyses and publishes automatically
- Week 3 — The same pipeline three ways, plus a written comparison
- Week 4 — Infrastructure created and destroyed with two commands
- Week 5 — A server never configured by hand, and a dashboard that reports breakage
- Week 6 — A production-shaped private network, deployed into by a pipeline
- Week 7 — The whole stack from one `docker compose up` , images published
- Week 8 — The app on Kubernetes from a Helm chart, cluster built by Terraform
- Week 9 — Full GitOps capstone: commit to Git reaches a live cluster on its own

Part 8 — Keeping admin near zero

- **Do not add new columns.** Everything needed is already there.
- **Do not tick tasks in advance.** A tracker that lies is worse than no tracker.

- **The only fields Yacoub edits are:** `Status` , `GitHub Evidence` , `LinkedIn URL` , `Notes` . Everything else is reference data set once at import.
- **If a day is missed**, do not reschedule 360 rows. Leave the dates alone and let the `Not Started` rows in the past stand as an honest record. The Tuesday/Thursday afternoons and Sunday catch-up slots exist to absorb slippage without redesigning the plan.
- **Weekly review, five minutes, every Sunday:** open THIS WEEK, look at anything still `Not Started` , and decide honestly whether to catch up or let it go. Then move on.

Troubleshooting the setup

Problem	Cause	Fix
Dates show as plain text, calendar view is empty	<code>Date</code> is still type Text	Change the property type to Date (Part 2)
Board view has one giant column	<code>Status</code> is still Text, not Select	Change to Select, then group by it again
TODAY view is empty	Filter set to "Is → Exact date" instead of "Is → Today"	Re-set the filter to the relative option Today
Import created 360 separate pages, not a database	You used "Merge with CSV" on a page instead of Import	Delete and redo Part 1 on a blank page
Special characters look wrong (â€™)	Editor opened the CSV and re-saved it as ANSI	Re-import the original file; it is UTF-8 with BOM